

Linear Coding for Gaussian Channels with Strictly Causal Side Information: Finite-blocklength Analysis

Fengyuan Ye*, Taejoon Kim*, Remi Chou†, Mohsen Moradi*

*School of Electrical, Computer and Energy Engineering, Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ 85281, USA
{fengyua5, taejoonkim, mmorad11}@asu.edu

†Department of Computer Science and Engineering, University of Texas at Arlington, Arlington, TX 76019, USA
remi.chou@uta.edu

Abstract—Channels with strictly causal interference side information arise when the encoder only has access to interference side information up to time step $i - 1$ at current step i . Despite their prevalence in sequential physical systems, coding designs for such channels remain largely unexplored. Traditional dirty-paper precoding methods are infeasible here, as they cannot eliminate interference solely based on past side information. To address the gap, this paper proposes a linear coding scheme for Gaussian channels with strictly causal interference side information by exploiting its connection to feedback channel coding. The proposed scheme achieves the channel capacity when the interference channel is noiseless. In the presence of both interference and noise, although the achievable rate asymptotically vanishes over infinite blocklengths, finite blocklength analysis indicates that the proposed linear scheme remains highly beneficial in high-interference regimes.

Index Terms—Strictly-causally known side information, linear coding, finite blocklength analysis, asymptotic rate.

I. INTRODUCTION

Additive Gaussian channels with interference state information at the encoder are categorized based on the encoder's knowledge at time step i over a total of N channel uses: non-causal (knowledge of the full sequence $\{1, \dots, N\}$), causal (knowledge up to step i), and strictly-causal (knowledge up to step $i - 1$). Remarkable progress has been made in channel coding for non-causally known interference. Costa [1] showed that when interference is known non-causally at the encoder, the channel capacity is identical to that of an interference-free channel. This landmark finding led to the development of dirty paper coding (DPC) [1], where the encoder pre-compensates for interference such that transmitted codewords are effectively orthogonal to interference. Erez et al. [2] subsequently utilized lattice quantization to extend DPC to the causal setting, showing that capacity loss vanishes as the lattice dimension approaches infinity. In contrast, the strictly-causal setting is far more constrained. Shannon [3] proved that access to independently and identically distributed (i.i.d.) strictly-causally known side information does not increase channel capacity. Traditional DPC-based schemes are inapplicable in this setting, as they require interference side information available causally. As a result, practical coding for strictly-causally known interference channels remains an open problem requiring fundamentally distinct design principles.

In this paper, we propose a linear coding scheme for additive Gaussian channels with strictly causal interference side information at the encoder. The underlying channel model motivates a feedback-oriented interpretation: since both settings rely exclusively on past side information, the strictly-causally known interference at the encoder exhibits fundamental similarities to feedback. Specifically, since the encoder observes the past interference sequence but lacks access to the additive channel noise, the system can be viewed as a form of a noisy feedback channel [4]–[7], where the encoder possesses partial side information. Our design principle centers on iteratively refining the interference estimate by leveraging the history of available side information.

The linear code design is first formulated as a signal-to-interference-plus-noise ratio (SINR) maximization problem subject to a power constraint, where the encoder and decoder parameters are derived via its equivalent power-minimization dual. Although the proposed linear scheme is capacity-achieving for noiseless interference channels, its achievable rate vanishes asymptotically in the presence of additive noise. Because asymptotic limits do not capture finite-latency behavior, we utilize the finite-blocklength framework [8] to identify the operational regimes where the scheme remains effective. Our analysis reveals that the proposed scheme is particularly advantageous in high-interference regimes. Specifically, when the interference power exceeds the noise power, we demonstrate the existence of a feasible target error probability ϵ for which the scheme achieves a rate $R > R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$, where $R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$ represents the maximum rate achievable with error probability ϵ for an additive white Gaussian noise (AWGN) interference channel without side information.

Notation. $\mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$ denotes a Gaussian distribution with mean μ and variance σ^2 . We write $f(x) = o(g(x))$ if $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = 0$, and $f(x) = O(g(x))$ if $\limsup_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{|f(x)|}{|g(x)|} < \infty$.

II. SYSTEM MODEL AND PROBLEM STATEMENT

The system model of the additive Gaussian channel with strictly causal interference side information at the encoder is shown in Figure 1. The message symbol θ is uniformly drawn over a rate R (bits/channel use) message set $\mathcal{C} =$

$\{\theta_1, \dots, \theta_M\}$ with $E[\theta^2] = 1$ and the message set size $M = 2^{NR}$, where the blocklength N is utilized for the transmission of one symbol $\theta \in \mathcal{C}$. The encoder has access to the strictly-causal interference side information $s_1^{i-1} = (s_1, \dots, s_{i-1})$ at the i -th channel use, where the interference $s_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_s^2)$ is i.i.d. The i -th channel input x_i is of the form, $x_i = \psi(\theta, s_1^{i-1})$, where ψ is the encoding function depending on the past side information s_1^{i-1} and message symbol θ . The i -th channel output is then given by

$$y_i = x_i + s_i + z_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, N, \quad (1)$$

where the additive i.i.d. noise $z_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ is assumed to be independent of s_i . The decoding process follows $\hat{\theta} = \phi(y_1, \dots, y_N)$, where ϕ is the decoding function to estimate transmitted symbol $\hat{\theta}$ from y_1^N . We put power constraint on x_i such that $\sum_{i=1}^N E[x_i^2] \leq NP$.

The encoder ψ is linear parameterized by a vector $\mathbf{g} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 1}$ to encode θ and a strictly lower-triangular matrix $\mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$ with zero diagonal to encode strictly causal interference. The linearly encoded transmit signal vector is

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{g}\theta + \mathbf{F}\mathbf{s}, \quad (2)$$

where $\mathbf{s} = [s_1, \dots, s_N]^T \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 1}$. The channel output is then

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{s} + \mathbf{z} = \mathbf{g}\theta + (\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})\mathbf{s} + \mathbf{z}. \quad (3)$$

The decoder ϕ employs a linear combiner $\mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 1}$ to estimate θ from $\mathbf{y}$,

$$\hat{\theta} = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{y} = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{g}\theta + \mathbf{w}^T ((\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})\mathbf{s} + \mathbf{z}). \quad (4)$$

Given the linear models in (2)-(4), our goal is to optimize $\mathbf{g}$, $\mathbf{F}$, and $\mathbf{w}$ to maximize the post-processing SINR, $\text{SINR} = \frac{E[\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{g}\theta]^2}{E[\mathbf{w}^T ((\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})\mathbf{s} + \mathbf{z})]^2}$ under a transmit power constraint. The SINR maximization problem is then given by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{K}: \quad & \max_{\mathbf{g}, \mathbf{F}, \mathbf{w}} \text{SINR} = \frac{|\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{g}|^2}{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{C} \mathbf{w}} \\ & \text{subject to} \quad \sum_{i=1}^N E[x_i^2] = \|\mathbf{g}\|^2 + \sigma_s^2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{F}\mathbf{F}^T) \leq NP, \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

where $\mathbf{C} = \sigma_s^2(\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})(\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})^T + \sigma^2 \mathbf{I}$ is the interference-plus-noise covariance matrix and $\text{tr}(\cdot)$ denotes the matrix trace.

This linear encoding and decoding framework is fundamentally rooted in the principles of feedback communication [4], [5] where the encoder utilizes past channel states to refine current transmission.

III. LINEAR CODING WITH STRICTLY CAUSAL INTERFERENCE SIDE INFORMATION

The proposed linear approach is inspired by the linear coding designs for noisy feedback channels established in [5]–[7], which we adapt here to the unique context of strictly-causal interference by treating past side information s_1^{i-1} as a form of noisy feedback.

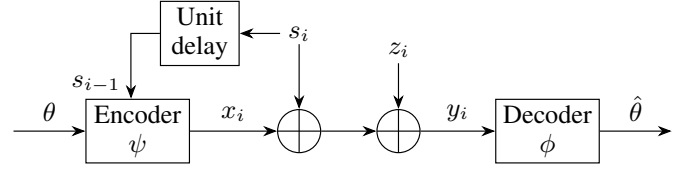


Figure 1: System model of the Gaussian channel with strictly causal interference side information at the encoder.

A. Linear Decoder Design

We define $\mathbf{g} = \mathbf{C}^{1/2} \mathbf{q}$, where $\mathbf{q} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 1}$. Then, by the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality, the following holds

$$\text{SINR} = \frac{|\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{C}^{1/2} \mathbf{q}|^2}{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{C} \mathbf{w}} \leq \frac{\|\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{C}^{1/2}\|^2 \|\mathbf{q}\|^2}{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{C} \mathbf{w}} = \|\mathbf{q}\|^2. \quad (6)$$

The upper bound is achieved with equality by choosing $\mathbf{q} = \alpha \mathbf{C}^{1/2} \mathbf{w}$ for $\alpha \neq 0$, i.e., $\mathbf{w} = \frac{1}{\alpha} \mathbf{C}^{-1/2} \mathbf{q} = \frac{1}{\alpha} \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}$. The unbiased estimate of $\hat{\theta}$ is obtained with $\alpha = \mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}$, where

$$\hat{\theta}_N = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{y} = \frac{\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{y}}{\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}}, \quad \mathbf{w} = \frac{\mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}}{\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}}. \quad (7)$$

Thus, the post-processing SINR is $\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g} = \|\mathbf{q}\|^2$, which is maximized when $\mathbf{g}$ is the eigenvector associated with minimum eigenvalue of $\mathbf{C}$, i.e., $\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})$. From $\mathbf{g} = \mathbf{C}^{1/2} \mathbf{q}$, it is immediately clear that

$$\mathbf{g} = \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})} \mathbf{q}. \quad (8)$$

Now, the expression for the transmit power constraint in (5) can be rewritten as $E[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}] = \mathbf{q}^T \mathbf{C} \mathbf{q} + \sigma_s^2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{F}\mathbf{F}^T) = \sigma_s^2 \|(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})^T \mathbf{q}\|^2 + \sigma^2 \|\mathbf{q}\|^2 + \sigma_s^2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{F}\mathbf{F}^T)$. Then, the linear coding parameters $\mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{F}$ are designed by considering an alternative SINR-constrained power minimization problem,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{J}: \quad & \min_{\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{F}} E[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}] = \sigma_s^2 \|(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})^T \mathbf{q}\|^2 + \sigma^2 \|\mathbf{q}\|^2 + \sigma_s^2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{F}\mathbf{F}^T) \\ & \text{subject to} \quad \|\mathbf{q}\|^2 = \eta, \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

where $\|\mathbf{q}\|^2 = \eta$ is a fixed SINR constraint. It is not difficult to show that the max-SINR problem $\mathcal{K}$ and the min-power problem $\mathcal{J}$ are equivalent. In what follows, we focus on optimizing $\mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{F}$ by solving $\mathcal{J}$.

B. Linear Encoder Design

We denote $[0, \dots, 0, \mathbf{f}_i^T]^T$ as the i th column of the strictly lower triangular matrix $\mathbf{F}$, where $\mathbf{f}_i = [f_{i+1,i}, \dots, f_{N,i}]^T \in \mathbb{R}^{(N-i) \times 1}$ and let $\mathbf{u}_i = [q_{i+1}, \dots, q_N]^T \in \mathbb{R}^{(N-i) \times 1}$ with $\mathbf{u}_0 = \mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{u}_N = \mathbf{0}$. Because $\mathbf{F}$ is unconstrained and $\|\mathbf{q}\|^2 = \eta$ does not depend on $\mathbf{F}$, we rewrite the objective of $\mathcal{J}$ element-wise as $\min_{\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{F}} E[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}] = \min_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_{i=1}^N \min_{\mathbf{f}_i} \sigma^2 q_i^2 + \sigma_s^2 (q_i + \mathbf{f}_i^T \mathbf{u}_i)^2 + \sigma_s^2 \|\mathbf{f}_i\|^2 \triangleq \min_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_{i=1}^N \min_{\mathbf{f}_i} J(q_i, \mathbf{f}_i)$. Solving for $\frac{\partial J(q_i, \mathbf{f}_i)}{\partial \mathbf{f}_i} = 0$ yields

$$\mathbf{f}_i = -\frac{q_i}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} \mathbf{u}_i. \quad (10)$$

Plugging (10) in $J(q_i, \mathbf{f}_i) = \sigma^2 q_i^2 + \sigma_s^2 (q_i + \mathbf{f}_i^T \mathbf{u}_i)^2 + \sigma_s^2 \|\mathbf{f}_i\|^2$ leads to $\min_{\mathbf{f}_i} J(q_i, \mathbf{f}_i) = q_i^2 \left(\sigma^2 + \frac{\sigma_s^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} \right) \triangleq \tilde{J}(q_i, \mathbf{u}_i)$. Then, the overall minimization in (9) reduces to,

$$\min_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_{i=1}^N \tilde{J}_i(q_i, \mathbf{u}_i) = \sigma^2 \eta - \sigma_s^2 N + \sigma_s^2 \min_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_{i=1}^N \left(1 + \frac{q_i^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} \right).$$

We note that $1 + \frac{q_i^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} = \frac{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_{i-1}\|^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2}$, and by following the arithmetic mean-geometric mean inequality, we get $\sum_{i=1}^N \frac{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_{i-1}\|^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} \geq N \left(\prod_{i=1}^N \frac{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_{i-1}\|^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} \right)^{1/N}$. This lower bound is achieved by choosing $\mathbf{q}$ in order to satisfy $\frac{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_{i-1}\|^2}{1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2} = \delta$, yielding

$$\delta = (1 + \eta)^{1/N}. \quad (11)$$

Thus, the minimum transmit power required to achieve the target SINR η in (9) is expressed as $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}] = \sigma^2 \eta - \sigma_s^2 N + \sigma_s^2 N(1 + \eta)^{1/N}$. Since $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}]$ is a monotonically increasing function of η , we can always find η that achieves

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}] = \sigma^2 \eta - \sigma_s^2 N + \sigma_s^2 N(1 + \eta)^{1/N} = NP. \quad (12)$$

Since $q_i^2 = (1 + \|\mathbf{u}_{i-1}\|^2) - (1 + \|\mathbf{u}_i\|^2) = \delta^{N-i+1} - \delta^{N-i}$, the entries of $\mathbf{q}$ are given by

$$q_i = \sqrt{(\delta - 1)\delta^{N-i}}, \quad i = 1, \dots, N. \quad (13)$$

By plugging (13) in (10) and after algebraic manipulations, each entry of the optimal $\mathbf{F}$ can be written as

$$f_{i+j,i} = -(\delta - 1)\delta^{-j/2}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N - i. \quad (14)$$

Regarding $\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})$ in (8), we have the following lemma.

Lemma 1. *The minimum eigenvalue of the interference-plus-noise covariance matrix $\mathbf{C}$ is $\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C}) = \sigma_s^2 \delta^{-(N-1)} + \sigma^2$.*

Proof. The proof is provided in Appendix A. ■

By Lemma 1, the θ encoding vector $\mathbf{g}$ has entries

$$g_i = \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})} q_i = \sqrt{(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2 \delta^{N-1})(\delta - 1)\delta^{-(i-1)}}. \quad (15)$$

C. SINR Bounds and Estimation Error Analysis

The minimum transmit power equality in (12) leads to

$$\frac{\eta}{N} = \frac{P}{\sigma^2} - \frac{\sigma_s^2}{\sigma^2} \left((1 + \eta)^{1/N} - 1 \right) \leq \frac{P}{\sigma^2}. \quad (16)$$

On the other hand, from (12)

$$NP \leq \sigma^2 \eta - \sigma_s^2 N + \sigma_s^2 N \left(1 + \frac{\eta}{N} \right) = (\sigma^2 + \sigma_s^2) \eta, \quad (17)$$

where the inequality follows from the fact that $(1 + \eta)^{1/N} \leq (1 + \eta/N)$ for $N \geq 1$. Combining (16) and (17) yields

$$N \left(\frac{P}{\sigma^2 + \sigma_s^2} \right) \leq \eta \leq N \frac{P}{\sigma^2}. \quad (18)$$

The lower bound is achieved when $N = 1$. The upper bound becomes tighter as N grows, implying the proposed scheme effectively cancels out the interference as $N \rightarrow \infty$.

The likelihood $p(\hat{\theta}|\theta)$ is conditionally Gaussian distributed with mean $\mathbb{E}[\hat{\theta}|\theta] = \theta$ and variance $\mathbb{E}[(\hat{\theta} - \theta)^2 | \theta] = \frac{1}{\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g}} = \frac{1}{\|\mathbf{q}\|^2} = \frac{1}{\eta}$, yielding

$$p(\hat{\theta} | \theta) = \sqrt{\frac{\eta}{2\pi}} \exp\left(-\frac{\eta(\hat{\theta} - \theta)^2}{2}\right). \quad (19)$$

An error occurs if there exists a symbol $\theta' \neq \theta$, $\theta', \theta \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $|\theta' - \hat{\theta}| \leq |\theta - \hat{\theta}|$. For M -ary pulse amplitude modulation (PAM), the distance between adjacent symbols is given by $d = 2\sqrt{\frac{3}{M^2 - 1}}$. Following the standard derivation for the average probability of error [9], P_e can be expressed as

$$P_e = \frac{M-1}{M} \int_{|\theta - \hat{\theta}| \geq \frac{d}{2}} p(\hat{\theta}|\theta) d\theta = \frac{M-1}{M} \operatorname{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3\eta}{2(M^2 - 1)}}\right), \quad (20)$$

where $\operatorname{erfc}(x) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} \int_x^\infty e^{-t^2} dt$. For a fixed M , the proposed scheme ensures that the error probability decays exponentially with the blocklength N .

D. Achievable Rate Analysis

Leveraging the SINR bounds in (18) and the error probability P_e in (20), we characterize the achievable rate of the proposed coding scheme. We first consider the case of noiseless interference channel, i.e., $z_i = 0$ in (1) and $\sigma^2 = 0$.

1) *Noiseless Interference Channel:* Under this channel, the capacity is expressed as $C_{\text{no-noise}} = \frac{1}{2} \log\left(1 + \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2}\right)$. From (12), the optimal SINR η is obtained as $\eta = \left(1 + \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2}\right)^N - 1$, implying the exponential growth of the SINR with the blocklength N . The probability of error is then expressed as

$$P_e = \left(1 - \frac{1}{2^{NR}}\right) \operatorname{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3}{2} \frac{2^{2NC_{\text{no-noise}}} - 1}{2^{2NR} - 1}}\right). \quad (21)$$

Consequently, in the limit as $N \rightarrow \infty$, $P_e \rightarrow 0$ for $R < C_{\text{no-noise}}$ and $P_e \rightarrow 1$ for $R > C_{\text{no-noise}}$. Regarding the achievability of $R = C_{\text{no-noise}}$, we have the following lemma.

Lemma 2. *The proposed linear scheme achieves the channel capacity $C_{\text{no-noise}}$ when the strictly-casually known interference channel is noiseless.*

Proof. We choose M to scale as $M = \sqrt{N^{(1-\epsilon)}(1 + \eta)}$, $\forall \epsilon > 1$. The achievable rate R is then computed as

$$\begin{aligned} R &= \frac{\log(M)}{N} = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{2} \frac{(1 - \epsilon) \log(N) + \sum_{i=1}^N \log(\delta)}{N} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \log\left(1 + \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2}\right), \end{aligned} \quad (22)$$

where the second equality is due to (11). By (20), as $N \rightarrow \infty$, $P_e = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{M-1}{M} \operatorname{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3}{2} \frac{1}{N^{(1-\epsilon)}(1 + \frac{1}{\eta}) - 1}}\right) = 0$. This concludes the proof. ■

Lemma 2 states that as $N \rightarrow \infty$, the probability of error P_e vanishes double-exponentially, while the codebook cardinality $|\mathcal{C}| = M$ grows exponentially. Consequently, the achievable rate R converges to $C_{\text{no-noise}}$.

2) *Noisy Interference Channel*: When the channel is subject to both noise and interference as in (1), we have the following lemma.

Lemma 3. *In the presence of both noise and interference in (1), the achievable rate R of the proposed linear coding scheme vanishes as $N \rightarrow \infty$.*

Proof. The achievable rate R is upper bounded by

$$NR = H(\theta) \leq I(\theta; \hat{\theta}) + 1 + NRP_e \quad (23)$$

$$= h(\hat{\theta}) - h(\hat{\theta}|\theta) + \epsilon_n \quad (24)$$

$$\leq \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi e(1 + 1/\eta)) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi e(1/\eta)) + \epsilon_n \quad (25)$$

$$\leq \frac{1}{2} \log\left(1 + N \frac{P}{\sigma^2}\right) + \epsilon_n, \quad (26)$$

where (23) follows from the Fano's inequality applied to the message θ with blocklength N and message set size $M = 2^{NR}$. P_e is the average error probability in (20) with $P_e \rightarrow 0$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$. In (24), $\epsilon_n \triangleq 1 + NRP_e$, which satisfies $\epsilon_n/N \rightarrow 0$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$. The inequality in (25) is due to (19) and the law of total variance, $\text{Var}(\hat{\theta}) = \text{Var}(\mathbb{E}[\hat{\theta}|\theta]) + \mathbb{E}[\text{Var}(\hat{\theta}|\theta)] = 1 + \frac{1}{\eta}$. The inequality in (26) follows from (18). Consequently, from (26), $\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} R \leq \frac{1}{2} \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\log(1 + N \frac{P}{\sigma^2})}{N} + \frac{\epsilon_n}{N} = 0$. Since R is non-negative, it concludes $R = 0$. ■

The results in Lemmas 2 and 3 share fundamental characteristics with the achievable rates established for linear feedback codes [4]–[6]. In the noiseless scenario, the availability of precise side information at the encoder enables the decoder to progressively refine prediction errors and achieve capacity. In the presence of noise, however, noise corrupts the encoded side information and prevents complete refinement, causing the asymptotic rate to vanish. While the zero achievable rate appears pessimistic, such asymptotic characterizations fail to capture the delicate behavior of rate and error performance in the finite-blocklength regime. This discrepancy motivates a rigorous characterization of the proposed coding scheme within the finite-blocklength regimes.

IV. FINITE-BLOCKLENGTH REGIME ANALYSIS

The asymptotic vanishing of the rate implies that for any $R > 0$, the error probability P_e remains bounded away from zero. This necessitates an analysis of the finite-blocklength performance to characterize the range of target error probabilities achievable by the proposed coding scheme for a fixed blocklength N .

Lemma 4. *For the proposed linear scheme with a fixed target error probability $\epsilon \in [\frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}(\sqrt{\frac{1}{2}\eta}), 1)$, the rate $R = \frac{\frac{1}{2} \log(1 + \frac{N}{\nu})}{N}$ is achievable for $0 \leq \nu \leq \frac{N}{3}$.*

Proof. From (18), for any $\rho \in [\frac{P}{\sigma^2 + \sigma_s^2}, \frac{P}{\sigma^2}]$, we get $\eta = N\rho$. For an achievable R , there exists $\nu \geq 0$ such that $R =$

$\frac{1}{2N} \log(1 + \frac{N}{\nu})$, in which the error probability can be rewritten as $P_e = \frac{M-1}{M} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3}{2} \frac{N\rho}{2^{NR}-1}}\right) = \frac{M-1}{M} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3}{2} \nu \rho}\right) < \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{3}{2} \nu \rho}\right)$. Since $M \geq 2$, ν should satisfy $\nu \leq \frac{N}{3}$, implying $\epsilon \geq \frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}(\sqrt{\frac{\eta}{2}})$. Since $0 \leq \nu \leq \frac{N}{3}$, the proposed linear scheme achieves target error probability $\epsilon \in [\frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}(\sqrt{\frac{\eta}{2}}), 1)$ with rate $R = \frac{1}{2N} \log(1 + \frac{N}{\nu})$. This completes the proof. ■

Remark. Lemma 4 establishes the characterizability of the finite-block-length analysis for the proposed linear coding scheme. It shows that the proposed coding scheme can support a non-zero rate while maintaining a target error probability $\epsilon \in [\frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}(\sqrt{\frac{1}{2}\eta}), 1)$. This motivates the selection of appropriate values for the transmission rate R , message size M , and blocklength N to ensure the effective operation of the scheme. Moreover, Lemma 4 also highlights that the interference power σ_s^2 and the noise power σ^2 are the primary factors affecting reliability performance.

According to Shannon [3], access to strictly-causally known interference does not increase channel capacity. In finite-blocklength regimes, we therefore define a baseline rate $R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$, as the maximum achievable rate for a target error probability ϵ over an AWGN interference channel as in (1) without side information at the encoder, where the channel SNR is given by $\rho = \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2}$. For a given target error probability ϵ , if the proposed scheme's achievable rate $R < R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$, it is considered suboptimal, as there exists another coding scheme that supports high achievable rate for ϵ without utilizing interference side information. Conversely if $R \geq R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$, the proposed scheme effectively leverages the available side information to outperform $R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon}$.

Theorem 1. *When the modulation size $M = 2$, we define ϵ as our target probability of error. Then for any fixed finite blocklength N , $R_{\text{no-SI}, \epsilon} = 0$ for $\epsilon < \frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}}\right)$, but the proposed linear scheme has rate $R = \frac{1}{N}$ to achieve $\epsilon \in [\frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2\sigma^2}}\right), \frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}}\right)]$.*

Proof. First we consider the case when the AWGN interference channel has no side information at encoder. When $M = 2$, the message set contains two symbols θ_1 and θ_2 uniformly distributed in $\mathcal{C}$. The encoding code vectors corresponding to θ_1 and θ_2 are denoted as $\mathbf{x}_1 \in \mathbb{R}^N$ and $\mathbf{x}_2 \in \mathbb{R}^N$ equiprobable and have equal transmit power NP respectively. Then the achievable probability of error [9] when $M = 2$ is expressed as

$$P_{e, \text{no-SI}} = \Pr((\mathbf{s} + \mathbf{z}) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_2) \geq \frac{d_{\text{no-SI}}^2}{2}) = \frac{1}{2} \text{erfc}\left(\sqrt{\frac{d_{\text{no-SI}}^2}{8(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}}\right), \quad (27)$$

where $d_{\text{no-SI}} = \|\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_2\|$ is the distance between the two

signals $\mathbf{x}_1$ and $\mathbf{x}_2$. It is further extended as

$$\begin{aligned} d_{\text{no-SI}}^2 &= \|\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_2\|^2 \\ &= \mathbf{x}_1^T \mathbf{x}_1 + \mathbf{x}_2^T \mathbf{x}_2 - 2\langle \mathbf{x}_1, \mathbf{x}_2 \rangle \\ &= 2NP - 2NP \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 \cdot \mathbf{x}_2}{\|\mathbf{x}_1\| \|\mathbf{x}_2\|}. \end{aligned} \quad (28)$$

Therefore, we obtain the minimum value of $d_{\text{no-SI}}$ when $\frac{\mathbf{x}_1 \cdot \mathbf{x}_2}{\|\mathbf{x}_1\| \|\mathbf{x}_2\|} = -1$, which means $\mathbf{x}_1$ and $\mathbf{x}_2$ are antipodal. The minimum value of $P_{e,\text{no-SI}}$ is obtained as

$$P_{e,\text{no-SI}}^* = \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}} \right). \quad (29)$$

This result implies that any target probability of error $\epsilon < P_{e,\text{no-SI}}^*$ is unattainable when $M = 2$. In other words, the achievable rate satisfies $R_{\text{no-SI},\epsilon} = 0$ for any $\epsilon < \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}} \right)$.

For the proposed coding scheme, when $M = 2$ according to (20), the achieved probability of error P_e is given by

$$P_e = \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{1}{2}} \eta \right). \quad (30)$$

Then according to SINR bound in (18), P_e is bounded as

$$\frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2\sigma^2}} \right) \leq P_e \leq \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma^2 + \sigma_s^2)}} \right). \quad (31)$$

In the end, we set $P_e = \epsilon$, then based on the bound in (31), there exist a target probability of error $\epsilon \in \left[\frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2\sigma^2}} \right), \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{erfc} \left(\sqrt{\frac{NP}{2(\sigma_s^2 + \sigma^2)}} \right) \right]$ is achievable with the proposed coding scheme $R = \frac{1}{N}$. ■

In summary, the finite blocklength analysis shows that our coding scheme provides performance gains. Theorem 1 demonstrates when $M = 2$, the proposed scheme can support a positive transmission rate to achieve a smaller target error which is unattainable by the baseline scenario in which the encoder has no access to interference side information.

V. CONCLUSION

This paper proposes a linear coding scheme for strictly-causally known interference channel. In the noiseless channel case, the proposed scheme is shown to achieve the channel capacity. The linear coding assumption inherently limits the achievable rate to zero in the presence of both interference and noise. Our finite-blocklength analysis highlights that the proposed scheme still offers advantages in the high-SINR regime. To address the zero-achievable-rate limitation, future work focuses on extending the proposed coding scheme by incorporating nonlinear or hybrid coding techniques. Motivated by the success of deep learning-based codes developed by Kim et al. [10] for noisy feedback channels, RNN autoencoder architecture is also potentially effective for strictly-causally known interference channel.

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APPENDIX A
PROOF OF LEMMA 1

The eigenvalue decomposition (EVD) of $\mathbf{C} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{Q}^T, \quad (32)$$

where $\mathbf{Q} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$ is a unitary matrix whose columns are the eigenvectors of $\mathbf{C}$, i.e., $\mathbf{Q}^T\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^T = \mathbf{I}$, and $\mathbf{\Lambda} = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N)$ contains the corresponding eigenvalues. Based on the EVD of $\mathbf{C}$, $\|\mathbf{q}\|^2$ is bounded by

$$\|\mathbf{q}\|^2 = \mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{C}^{-1} \mathbf{g} = \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{(\mathbf{Q}_i^T \mathbf{g})^2}{\lambda_i} \leq \frac{\mathbf{g}^T \mathbf{g}}{\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})}, \quad (33)$$

and maximizing $\|\mathbf{q}\|^2$ leads to (8). Thus, $\mathbf{q}$ is the eigenvector associated with the minimum eigenvalue of $\mathbf{C}$, i.e.,

$$\mathbf{C}\mathbf{q} = \sigma_s^2(\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})^T(\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{I})\mathbf{q} + \sigma^2\mathbf{q} = \lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C})\mathbf{q}. \quad (34)$$

The i -th element of $(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})^T\mathbf{q}$ can be expressed as

$$\begin{aligned} & [(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})(\mathbf{I} + \mathbf{F})^T\mathbf{q}]_i \\ &= q_i + \sum_{k=i+1}^N f_{k,i}q_k + \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} f_{i,k} \left(q_k + \sum_{\ell=k+1}^N f_{\ell,k}q_\ell \right) \\ &= q_i + \sum_{k=i+1}^N -(\delta-1)\delta^{-(k-i)}q_i \\ &\quad + \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} -(\delta-1) \left(q_i + \sum_{\ell=k+1}^N -(\delta-1)\delta^{-(\ell-k)}q_i \right) \end{aligned} \quad (35)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= q_i + q_i \sum_{k=i+1}^N -(\delta-1)\delta^{-(k-i)} \\ &\quad + q_i \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} -(\delta-1) \left(1 + \sum_{\ell=k+1}^N -(\delta-1)\delta^{-(\ell-k)} \right) \\ &= q_i \left[1 - (\delta-1) \sum_{j=1}^{N-i} \delta^{-j} \right. \\ &\quad \left. - (\delta-1) \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} \left(1 - (\delta-1) \sum_{j=1}^{N-k} \delta^{-j} \right) \right] \end{aligned} \quad (36)$$

$$= q_i \left[1 - (\delta-1) \sum_{j=1}^{N-i} \delta^{-j} - (\delta-1) \sum_{k=1}^{i-1} \delta^{-(N-k)} \right] \quad (37)$$

$$= q_i \left[1 - (\delta-1) \left(\sum_{j=1}^{N-i} \delta^{-j} + \sum_{j=N-i+1}^{N-1} \delta^{-j} \right) \right] \quad (38)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= q_i \left[1 - (\delta-1) \sum_{j=1}^{N-1} \delta^{-j} \right] \\ &= q_i \delta^{-(N-1)}, \end{aligned} \quad (39)$$

where (35) is due to the equalities $q_k = \delta^{-(k-i)/2}q_i$ and $f_{k,i}q_k = -(\delta-1)\delta^{-(k-i)}q_i$, (36) is due to the equalities $\sum_{k=i+1}^N \delta^{-(k-i)} = \sum_{j=1}^{N-i} \delta^{-j}$ and $\sum_{\ell=k+1}^N \delta^{-(\ell-k)} = \sum_{j=1}^{N-k} \delta^{-j}$, (37) is due to the geometric sum equality $1 - (\delta-1) \sum_{j=1}^{N-k} \delta^{-j} = 1 - (1 - \delta^{-(N-k)}) = \delta^{-(N-k)}$, and (38) follows from the fact that $\sum_{k=1}^{i-1} \delta^{-(N-k)} = \sum_{j=N-i+1}^{N-1} \delta^{-j}$ with $j = N-k$. Therefore, from (39), the minimum eigenvalue of $\mathbf{C}$ is given by $\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{C}) = \sigma_s^2 \delta^{-(N-1)} + \sigma^2$, and this completes the proof.

APPENDIX B
DERIVATIONS OF SINR FOR $\sigma_s^2 > \sigma^2$

Defining $p = \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2}$ for $k = \frac{\sigma_s^2}{\sigma^2} > 1$ leads to

$$\begin{aligned} \eta + 1 &= \left(1 + p - \frac{\eta}{kN} \right)^N \\ &= (1+p)^N \left(1 - \frac{\eta}{kN(1+p)} \right)^N \\ &\geq (1+p)^N \left(1 - \frac{\eta}{k(1+p)} \right), \end{aligned} \quad (40)$$

where the lower bound in the last step is due to the Bernoulli's inequality $(1 - \frac{\eta}{kN(1+p)})^N \geq 1 - \frac{\eta}{k(1+p)}$ for $\frac{\eta}{kN(1+p)} \in [0, 1]$. The inequality in (40) can be rewritten as

$$\eta \left(1 + \frac{(1+p)^{N-1}}{k} \right) \geq (1+p)^N - 1. \quad (41)$$

Restoring the original parameters by setting $p = \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2}$, we obtain the following lower bound for η ,

$$\eta \geq \frac{\left(1 + \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2} \right)^N - 1}{1 + \frac{\left(1 + \frac{P}{\sigma_s^2} \right)^{N-1}}{k}}. \quad (42)$$